

Executive Recommendation and Course *Wrap-Up*

Module 6, Part 3 (December 5)

QBA 5330

From Technical Answer to Recommendation

The course outline's own steps for this case:

1. Define variables, objective, constraints – in words
 2. Build and solve in Solver
 3. Identify the optimal quantities
 4. Identify binding and non-binding constraints
 5. Explain the managerial meaning of unused capacity
 6. Conduct **one** what-if analysis
 7. Write a one-page executive recommendation
- **Parts 1–2 covered 1–6 with given examples. Now: design your own.**

Team Worksheet

1. **Design your own what-if scenario** – a specific number, not “more capacity would help”
2. **Evaluate it** against the Sensitivity Report
3. **Explain, in plain language**, what Petro’s 1,200 unused distillation hours actually mean
4. **Write a one-paragraph executive recommendation**

Report-Outs

Which resource did your team prioritize – and why?

Course Wrap-Up: The Full Decision Cycle

Step	Where it lived
Frame the decision	Module 1
Obtain data	Module 1
Summarize evidence	Module 1
Quantify uncertainty	Modules 2–3
Build a model	Modules 4–5
Recommend an action	Module 6 – today
Communicate the result	Every deliverable, all course long

What Module 6 Added

“Recommend an action” stopped being a qualitative judgment call.

It became a literal, computable answer.

Looking Ahead: The Final Exam

- Selecting the right method
- Interpreting R and Excel output
- Recognizing a method's limitations
- Making a defensible business recommendation
- **Not lengthy hand calculations – exactly what this course has practiced all along.**